

Playground Songs & Rhymes





About the Course

Develop hand-eye coordination while playing with words and rhythm using ball-bouncing, passing, and clapping games.

This topic is included in the following course(s): PE: Grades 1-3

PE: Grades 1-3

Lessons specifically created for Grades 1-6. We recommend you make sure to include some sort of physical activity as breaks throughout your school day. If you already have sports or similar activities as a regular part of your life rhythms, these lessons are optional.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
1-3	Playground Songs & Rhymes 1 time/week 20 min	The Book of Playground Songs & Rhymes

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
PE: Grades 1-3				
Jump Rope	Free Play	Playground Songs & Rhymes	Free Play	Folk Dancing



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

PE: Grades 1-3

☐ Read the Introduction for Playground Songs & Rhymes p.5

☐ Bookmark the song playlist on SoundCloud. These include songs for folk dances, playground songs and rhymes, and jump rope. Create a free SoundCloud account to use offline. There are links to individual songs in lessons.

☐ Preview games and songs.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Playground Songs & Rhymes



The Book of Playground Songs & Rhymes



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

∞ [View Supply List Details](#)

Playground Songs & Rhymes



Rhythm Sticks



Quick Links

Related Course Quick Links

∞ [Extra Helpings](#)

∞ [SoundCloud Song Playlist](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Playground Songs & Rhymes

How To Teach



Overview

Mason emphasized that being physically fit is just as important as being mentally and spiritually fit. She used a combination of Swedish Drill (calisthenic exercises done to music or military-style commands), playground games, sports, dance, free play, and afternoon walks to make sure students had time for vigorous exercise every single day.



Introduce

Teach students the new song, dance, or sport. Tutorials are often provided.



Practice

Play your new game, practice your new dance, sing your new rhyme, etc.!

Playground Songs & Rhymes

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 20m Playground Songs & Rhymes - Lesson 1

Hand Clapping: Song & Rhythm

Materials: Playground Songs & Rhymes

PREP: Learn song and motions.
"Hot Cross Buns" p.15

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

1. Listen to the song several times.
 2. Listen and repeat one line at a time.
 3. Clap to the rhythm while you sing.
- ∞ Audio Link: Hot Cross Buns

WEEK 2 20m Playground Songs & Rhymes - Lesson 2

Hand Clapping: Motions - Hot Cross Buns

→ RECAP

Sing the song with the audio.

→ PRACTICE

1. Learn motions, saying them while moving.
 2. Sing the name of motions to the rhythm.
 3. Listen to audio while doing motions.
- ∞ Audio Link: Hot Cross Buns

WEEK 3 20m Playground Songs & Rhymes - Lesson 3

Hand Clapping: Motions & Singing - Hot Cross Buns

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

1. Listen to audio while doing motions.
 2. Sing the song while doing motions.
- ∞ Audio Link: Hot Cross Buns

WEEK 4 20m Playground Songs & Rhymes - Lesson 4

Hand Clapping: Practice & Variations - Hot Cross Buns

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Practice motions while singing the song. Experiment with various speeds if ready.

∞ Audio Link: Hot Cross Buns

WEEK 5 20m Playground Songs & Rhymes - Lesson 5

Passing Game: Song & Rhythm

Materials: Playground Songs & Rhymes

PREP: Learn song and motions.
"Where, Oh, Where" p.85

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

1. Listen to the song several times.
 2. Listen and repeat one line at a time.
 3. Clap to the rhythm while you sing.
- ∞ Audio Link: Where, Oh, Where

WEEK 6 20m Playground Songs & Rhymes - Lesson 6

Passing Game: Motions - Where, Oh, Where

→ RECAP

Sing the song with the audio.

Playground Songs & Rhymes

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

→ PRACTICE

1. Learn motions, saying them while moving.
 2. Sing the name of motions to the rhythm.
 3. Listen to audio while doing motions.
- ∞ Audio Link: Where, Oh, Where

WEEK 7 20m Playground Songs & Rhymes - Lesson 7

Passing Game: Motions & Singing - Where, Oh, Where

📄 Materials: Rhythm Stick (or other object to pass)

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

1. Listen to the audio while doing motions.
 2. Sing the song while doing motions.
- ∞ Audio Link: Where, Oh, Where

WEEK 8 20m Playground Songs & Rhymes - Lesson 8

Passing Game: Practice & Variations - Where, Oh, Where

📄 Materials: Rhythm Stick (or other object to pass)

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Practice motions while singing the song. Experiment with various speeds if ready.

∞ Audio Link: Where, Oh, Where

WEEK 9 20m Playground Songs & Rhymes - Lesson 9

Practice: Both Songs - Hot Cross Buns; Where, Oh, Where

📄 Materials: Rhythm Stick (or other object to pass)

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Sing with the audio once and then without, combining with motions.

∞ Audio Link: Hot Cross Buns

∞ Audio Link: Where, Oh, Where

WEEK 10 20m Playground Songs & Rhymes - Lesson 10

Practice: Both Songs - Hot Cross Buns; Where, Oh, Where

📄 Materials: Rhythm Stick (or other object to pass)

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Sing with the audio once and then without, combining with motions.

∞ Audio Link: Hot Cross Buns

∞ Audio Link: Where, Oh, Where

WEEK 11 20m Playground Songs & Rhymes - Lesson 11

Practice: Both Songs - Hot Cross Buns; Where, Oh, Where

📄 Materials: Rhythm Stick (or other object to pass)

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Sing with the audio once and then without, combining with motions.

∞ Audio Link: Hot Cross Buns

∞ Audio Link: Where, Oh, Where

WEEK 12 20m Playground Songs & Rhymes - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Playground Songs & Rhymes

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Term 1

Questions will come from:
Playground Songs & Rhymes & Book of Song Dances

Playground Songs & Rhymes

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 1 20m Playground Songs & Rhymes - Lesson 13

Hand Clapping: Song & Rhythm

Materials: Playground Songs & Rhymes

PREP: Learn song and motions.
Say, Say, My Playmate p.24

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

1. Listen to the song several times.
 2. Listen and repeat one line at a time.
 3. Clap to the rhythm while you sing.
- ∞ Audio Link: Say, Say, My Playmate

WEEK 2 20m Playground Songs & Rhymes - Lesson 14

Hand Clapping: Motions - Say, Say, My Playmate

→ RECAP

Sing the song with the audio.

→ PRACTICE

1. Learn motions, saying them while moving.
 2. Sing the name of motions to the rhythm.
 3. Listen to audio while doing motions.
- ∞ Audio Link: Say, Say, My Playmate

WEEK 3 20m Playground Songs & Rhymes - Lesson 15

Hand Clapping: Motions & Singing - Say, Say, My Playmate

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

1. Listen to audio while doing motions.
 2. Sing the song while doing motions.
- ∞ Audio Link: Say, Say, My Playmate

WEEK 4 20m Playground Songs & Rhymes - Lesson 16

Hand Clapping: Practice & Variations - Say, Say, My Playmate

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Practice motions while singing the song. Experiment with various speeds if ready.

∞ Audio Link: Say, Say, My Playmate

WEEK 5 20m Playground Songs & Rhymes - Lesson 17

Passing Game: Song & Rhythm

Materials: Playground Songs & Rhymes

PREP: Learn song and motions.
"Obwisana" p.81

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

1. Listen to the song several times.
 2. Listen and repeat one line at a time.
 3. Clap to the rhythm while you sing.
- ∞ Audio Link: Obwisana

WEEK 6 20m Playground Songs & Rhymes - Lesson 18

Passing Game: Motions - Obwisana

→ RECAP

Sing the song with the audio.

Playground Songs & Rhymes

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

→ PRACTICE

1. Learn motions, saying them while moving.
 2. Sing the name of motions to the rhythm.
 3. Listen to audio while doing motions.
- ∞ Audio Link: Obwisana

WEEK 7 20m Playground Songs & Rhymes - Lesson 19

Passing Game: Motions & Singing - Obwisana

📄 Materials: Rhythm Stick (or other object to pass)

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

1. Listen to the audio while doing motions.
 2. Sing the song while doing motions.
- ∞ Audio Link: Obwisana

WEEK 8 20m Playground Songs & Rhymes - Lesson 20

Passing Game: Practice & Variations - Obwisana

📄 Materials: Rhythm Stick (or other object to pass)

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Practice motions while singing the song. Experiment with various speeds if ready.

∞ Audio Link: Obwisana

WEEK 9 20m Playground Songs & Rhymes - Lesson 21

Practice: Both Songs - Say, Say, My Playmate; Obwisana

📄 Materials: Rhythm Stick (or other object to pass)

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Sing with the audio once and then without, combining with motions.

∞ Audio Link: Say, Say, My Playmate

∞ Audio Link: Obwisana

WEEK 10 20m Playground Songs & Rhymes - Lesson 22

Practice: Both Songs - Say, Say, My Playmate; Obwisana

📄 Materials: Rhythm Stick (or other object to pass)

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Sing with the audio once and then without, combining with motions.

∞ Audio Link: Say, Say, My Playmate

∞ Audio Link: Obwisana

WEEK 11 20m Playground Songs & Rhymes - Lesson 23

Practice: Both Songs - Say, Say, My Playmate; Obwisana

📄 Materials: Rhythm Stick (or other object to pass)

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Sing with the audio once and then without, combining with motions.

∞ Audio Link: Say, Say, My Playmate

∞ Audio Link: Obwisana

WEEK 12 20m Playground Songs & Rhymes - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Playground Songs & Rhymes

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Term 2

Questions will come from:
Playground Songs & Rhymes & Book of Song Dances

Playground Songs & Rhymes

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Term 3

WEEK 1 20m Playground Songs & Rhymes - Lesson 25

Hand Clapping: Song & Rhythm

Materials: Playground Songs & Rhymes

PREP: Learn song and motions.

"My Momma Gave Me a Nickel" p.22

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

1. Listen to the song several times.
 2. Listen and repeat one line at a time.
 3. Clap to the rhythm while you sing.
- ∞ Audio Link: My Momma Gave Me a Nickel

WEEK 2 20m Playground Songs & Rhymes - Lesson 26

Hand Clapping: Motions - My Momma Gave Me a Nickel

→ RECAP

Sing the song with the audio.

→ PRACTICE

1. Learn motions, saying them while moving.
 2. Sing the name of motions to the rhythm.
 3. Listen to audio while doing motions.
- ∞ Audio Link: My Momma Gave Me a Nickel

WEEK 3 20m Playground Songs & Rhymes - Lesson 27

Hand Clapping: Motions & Singing - My Momma Gave Me a Nickel

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

1. Listen to audio while doing motions.
 2. Sing the song while doing motions.
- ∞ Audio Link: My Momma Gave Me a Nickel

WEEK 4 20m Playground Songs & Rhymes - Lesson 28

Hand Clapping: Practice & Variations - My Momma Gave Me a Nickel

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Practice motions while singing the song. Experiment with various speeds if ready.

∞ Audio Link: My Momma Gave Me a Nickel

WEEK 5 20m Playground Songs & Rhymes - Lesson 29

Passing Game: Song & Rhythm

Materials: Playground Songs & Rhymes

PREP: Learn song and motions.

"I Pass the Shoe" p.79

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

1. Listen to the song several times.
 2. Listen and repeat one line at a time.
 3. Clap to the rhythm while you sing.
- ∞ Audio Link: I Pass the Shoe

WEEK 6 20m Playground Songs & Rhymes - Lesson 30

Passing Game: Motions - I Pass the Shoe

→ RECAP

Sing the song with the audio.

Playground Songs & Rhymes

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ PRACTICE

1. Learn motions, saying them while moving.
 2. Sing the name of motions to the rhythm.
 3. Listen to audio while doing motions.
- ∞ Audio Link: I Pass the Shoe

WEEK 7 20m Playground Songs & Rhymes - Lesson 31

Passing Game: Motions & Singing - I Pass the Shoe

📄 Materials: Rhythm Stick (or other object to pass)

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

1. Listen to the audio while doing motions.
 2. Sing the song while doing motions.
- ∞ Audio Link: I Pass the Shoe

WEEK 8 20m Playground Songs & Rhymes - Lesson 32

Passing Game: Practice & Variations - I Pass the Shoe

📄 Materials: Rhythm Stick (or other object to pass)

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Practice motions while singing the song. Experiment with various speeds if ready.

∞ Audio Link: I Pass the Shoe

WEEK 9 20m Playground Songs & Rhymes - Lesson 33

Practice: Both Songs - My Momma Gave Me a Nickel, I Pass the Shoe

📄 Materials: Rhythm Stick (or other object to pass)

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Sing with the audio once and then without, combining with motions.

∞ Audio Link: My Momma Gave Me a Nickel

∞ Audio Link: I Pass the Shoe

WEEK 10 20m Playground Songs & Rhymes - Lesson 34

Practice: Both Songs - My Momma Gave Me a Nickel, I Pass the Shoe

📄 Materials: Rhythm Stick (or other object to pass)

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Sing with the audio once and then without, combining with motions.

∞ Audio Link: My Momma Gave Me a Nickel

∞ Audio Link: I Pass the Shoe

WEEK 11 20m Playground Songs & Rhymes - Lesson 35

Practice: Both Songs - My Momma Gave Me a Nickel, I Pass the Shoe

📄 Materials: Rhythm Stick (or other object to pass)

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Sing with the audio once and then without, combining with motions.

∞ Audio Link: My Momma Gave Me a Nickel

∞ Audio Link: I Pass the Shoe

WEEK 12 20m Playground Songs & Rhymes - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Playground Songs & Rhymes

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Term 3

Questions will come from:
Playground Songs & Rhymes & Book of Song Dances

Playground Songs & Rhymes

Examination

- Term 1** · Perform "Hot Cross Buns" OR "Where, Oh, Where" for the teacher to observe.
- Term 2** · Perform "Say, Say, My Playmate" OR "Obwisana" for the teacher to observe.
- Term 3** · Perform "My Momma Gave Me a Nickel" OR "I Pass the Shoe" for the teacher to observe.